

If you hate AI because of the pollution, just remember that pollution mainly comes from petrochemical derivatives

Posted by u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 0 points • 37 comments

We have bigger priorities to fight against when it comes to pollution!

Comments

u/Competitive-Gear2813 • 1 points • 2025-11-01 15:41 UTC

You're absolutely right; petrochemical pollution is a giant problem-it has historically dominated the scene, polluting our air, water, and soil. It's a huge driver of climate change, plastic waste.

But we can't deny that AI and data centers are a rapidly growing source of environmental footprint. Think of it this way:

Power Hungry: Training and running large AI models guzzle massive amounts of electricity, which pumps out a lot of carbon if it's not from green sources.

Thirsty Data: Those big data centers require enormous amounts of water for cooling, sometimes placing a real strain on local supplies.

Hardware and Waste: Most critical minerals have to be mined to develop AI chips, and in the end, generate a lot of [e-waste](<https://getenviropass.com/weeee/>).

So, whereas the long-standing heavy hitters are oil and gas derivatives, the impact of AI is a serious, emerging issue we need to keep an eye on.

u/jthadcast • 1 points • 2025-09-12 11:01 UTC

right, ai isn't made by that garbage pile of "petrochemical derivatives" it is built from making that pile of garbage bigger.

u/SillyBacchus303 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 19:21 UTC

"Alright officer I *did* commit the school shooting. But Hitler killed millions, he's far worse! By that logic, I am innocent and should keep killing people"

u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 1 points • 2025-09-12 00:34 UTC

Bro I already said why this analogy is genuinely nuerentky wrong, just go check the other comments

If you're referring to [this comment](https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/s/bCNfAlnvbj)

The main difference between AI and petroleum is that we're already highly dependent on petroleum while AI is new and stoppable.

Most things we use every day use petroleum derivatives and some countries' economy runs on selling oil and would be much poorer if they couldn't. So in a way, selling oil feeds children lol. To completely stop using petroleum derivatives it would need herculean efforts and a shit ton of money and innovations, so while we must work on it we can't do anything about it rn.

On the other hand, generative AI is brand new, we're not dependent on it (at least not yet) and it's already directly ruining lives. It's easily stoppable (simply by passing a law) and while the multi-billions companies might lose a bit of money it would make a lot of people's lives better and protect human art.

If we wait until we solve the petroleum derivatives problem nothing is going to change for a long time

u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 1 points • 2025-09-12 04:55 UTC

Doesn't it already hint that AI isn't the main problem pollution wise if you can literally just... stop consuming it?

The fact oil runs economies doesn't mean it's good, we're talking about it's pollutive markers, not economical outputs

And sure, it would be stupidly hard to stop using petroleum or reducing it, but here's the thing: if you actually do care about pollution, you would already be protesting about the insanity of literally having to pollute the world from idk... buying a literal instant ramen

AI as a tool will of course ruin lives, but saying that stop using it will "save lives and protect art" are incorrect when you take a nuance into it, AI already saves lives medically since they are used as tools in medical healthcare

And no human art will ever be truly protected, there will always be plagiarism, sabotaging, destruction and oppression of many human art works, and even in that situation a convolutional neuronal network does not steal art works, unless... you ask it to (very morally questionable)

And tell me, if stopping the possible nuclear explosion that is petroleum later and prioritize the trash fire that is AI, what good is there in that?

Ever since the 70s or even less it has been known that the main objective to crumble down is petroleum

(Btw many of your points are unrelated to the pollutive point)

I know that petroleum is terrible ecologically speaking but many depend on it and given how long it will take us to stop using it I think it's fair to stop smaller sources at the same time

It's not because the petroleum problem isn't fixed that you don't sort your trash

And when I was talking about AI I meant generative AI which brings nothing significant to humanity

By "protecting human art" I meant that the last pieces of human art will be flooded in the industrially produced mass of generated images

Obviously I don't like pollution but I'm not ready to change all my habits for that, like every other human being I like comfort and won't make a lot of efforts if I don't have any alternative or if the alternatives don't become cheaper (I'm not really an ecology activist even tho I think it's important, if I'm talking about ecology rn it's because it's the point of the post lol)

If the neighbouring city is on fire it's not a reason to not throw a glass of water on the burning houseplant

u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 1 points •
2025-09-12 12:55 UTC

And that's what's so remarkably important, petroleum is deeply rooted onto us, that's just how bad it is

And I've already remarked, by prioritizing I don't mean "leave everything behind" I mean... prioritizing! You put it as the main substance to take over, obviously you'll still follow up other logically coherent ideas

By the way, generative art is already how almost all AIs work, specially because of their neuronal networks, they don't "steal" information, they study it

And look, I get the fear for industrialization, but that has already happened to for example the Mona Lisa, which has been

used for advertisement and modern merchandising, and yet it did not remove the true value of such painting, because it does not truly represent what was original

And.. yeah, neither do I, but maybe we have to, I mean sure it can even be impossible, but what good is to live when you're surrounded by poison?

I think the city analogy is good, that is true, but the thing is that the fire city is less controllable thereby it has to be reinforced with more measurements

I do not say "do not regulate AI" I say that petroleum should be protested to be regulated if society were to actually care about pollution

u/SirJohn-redditor • 1 points • 2025-09-11 05:11 UTC

Yeahyeah that's cool and all but dude that music paired with that imagery? Magnificent, thank you for showing us this.

u/morerandom__2025 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 02:18 UTC

Most ocean and river pollution comes from South Asia and east Asia specifically

Let's point the fingers in the right direction

u/wget_thread • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:32 UTC

The entire human collective of 8 billion people can only address one problem at a time guys, every other problem please take a number.

u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:34 UTC

Uh.. yeah, as crazy as it may seem

AI is not enough of a threat (currently) to be taken as a world wide pollutive threat, yet we remain silent about how literally half of the objects in your household are made of a petroleum derivate

You can live without AI perfectly, but not without petroleum, that already hints that AI should probably be a secondary concern

u/wget_thread • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:41 UTC

It's just a easy and logically consistent to say that it's easier to tackle the things more within our control first, (such as not using AI), but you've entirely missed the point that the human race **can** walk and chew gum at the same time. Porque no los dos?

Focusing on a singular issue to this level of obsessive selectivism is literally how you get stuck in "red vs blue team" single-issue voter politics instead of tackling systemic problems. Your single issue just happens to be supporting AI.

u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:44 UTC

I'm not saying AI doesn't harm the world if anything it's harm it's already catastrophic

But petroleum companies do genuinely thousands of times worst, almost all pollutive problem comes from petroleum

It's not a red vs blue, it's a "we should probably turn off the overheating nuclear reactor before turning off the trash fire occurring in the facility"

u/wget_thread • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:53 UTC

I didn't say it **was** red vs blue. I was outlining that this type of issue weighing is exactly **how** that shit starts, instead of looking at entrenched power structures that enable both types of negative environmental outcomes. I'm not going to live in some contrived trolley problem version of reality where it is a societal level binary choice between every comparative set of environmental danger and we can only pick one to address between them. It reads a bit apologist to me and akin to "Dupont lied to us, Dow lied to us, maybe we should hear OpenAI and Meta out? Maybe it's just growing pains?" Maybe waiting for something to escalate from catastrophe to existential threat isn't the only strategy, again for a world **full** of people with varying expertise and ability.

u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:57 UTC

But you did say it was red vs blue, you quite literally said "focusing on a single issue to this level of obsessive selectivism is how you get stuck in red vs blue team analogies" the simple fact of implying it may happen already says that you are implying it is such thing

Anyways, I already said "AI has catastrophic consequences, but petroleum is known for being somehow worst"

It's not apologist, because I'm not saying "just let the AI companies

do whatever they want”, I’m saying “both industries are bad, but mainly targeting on a industry that is barely harming as much the earth as literal buckets of petro chemical paint, is something we should really take in mind

u/Connect-Way5293 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:29 UTC

One hamburgers cobsumed enuff water to make ai

u/Loud_House8202 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:25 UTC

![gif](giphy|1fM9ePvIVcqZ2)

u/Empathy_Swamp • 1 points • 2025-09-11 01:06 UTC

This is not a case of A or B, it is a case of A and B. Both are polluting, we can address both at the same time.

u/Agreeable_Credit_436 • 2 points • 2025-09-11 01:13 UTC

that is true, but people have started to forget the main target, pollutions main productor is petroleum, and it apparently somehow will always be (I say this with a surprising tone)

but if we were to truly care about pollution, it feels intellectually flawed to first attack a target like AI industries when they barely do any harm compared to for example... something as simple as paint! (the main microplastic in the ocean is the paint we use to paint our walls, which is a petroleum derivate)

u/No-Investment2221 • 1 points • 2025-09-12 06:52 UTC

Some people will never pivot. Some people see AI as the byproduct of billionaires and CEOs to enslave society. So it will always be something with AI until it is so integrated in our society and making our lives way easier, that people will jump to the next crusade. Progress is progress. At least, we are the closest we have been to a lot of medical breakthroughs (in part thanks to AI).